claim that. Rajnath Singh and Nitin Gadkari had their own sets of qualities. Amit Shah focuses on party functions and structures more intensely. He practically travelled to almost all the districts and he kept party workers engaged in one campaign or another, one after the other. At the same time, he paid a significant amount of attention to institutionalisation of the political party. For example, his keenness that, for every district headquarter, we should have our own premises. Today, in more than 300 districts, it has been completed [this was in August 2019]. His insistence that every party office must have its own library. It has been completed. Then there is big party membership drive and his idea of writing the history of every BJP unit.'[92]

Of course, the archival exercise did not work uniformly in all states. When party workers were asked to start taking pictures of every event they organised and uploading them as part of an ongoing archival project, some did better than others, while many remained laggards. 'Questions will always be raised,' Sahasrabuddhe told me. 'But the attempt should be made. What he used to tell us is that if you do any activity, take a picture on your mobile phone and send it. Then send a small description of it, so we remember who said what. At least the idea was initiated. How it goes ahead one doesn't know. The party did not have this earlier.'

'Structured functioning matters a great deal,' he adds. 'It is my observation that the entire political mainstream of activism in our country is like *kafan bandh ke nikle hain* [literally, as if they have set out with coffins on their heads, to mean that they set out rashly, as if prepared to die]. We should do things in a systematic way, with a longer-term view. But when political activity happens, mostly these structural things take a backseat and people just put a coffin on their head and jump across. We are trying to change that with this systemic organisational work.'[93]

The work he describes includes creating histories. As Shah told BJP workers in Bhopal, 'In twenty years scholars from across the world will want to study the history, evolution, characteristics ideology and various dimensions of our party. It is already happening, and there should be material which we should be able to